NICONET™

NICHOLSON STAFF INTRANET · STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

SOP · N3-C · CLEANING

The move-in clean

Clocking in and out, photos and the Cleaning Matrix

You are the last person in the home before the tenant. How you leave it is how they will see it, and it forms their impression of us, the team and the brand. Your work is crucially important.

WHO IT IS FOR

Cleaners, and anyone carrying out a move-in or communal clean.

WHERE TO FIND IT

NicoNet › SOP, under the instructional film. Read it in full before your first job, then keep it to hand.

DOWNLOAD NICONET™

Scan with your phone camera to download NicoNet from the App Store or Google Play (published by Nicholson Lettings Limited). Sign in with your work email and the six-digit code we email you.

living.nicholsongroup.co.uk/get/niconet

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PURPOSE

1 Why your clean matters

A tenant forms an opinion in the first minute, with every sense: what they see, what they smell, what they touch. A dirty-mop smell or a dusty skirting will put them off however good the home looks.

Last

You are last in the apartment. Nobody follows you to put things right.

First

Your clean is the tenant's first impression of Nicholson.

Every

Every clean follows N3 Cleaning and the Cleaning Matrix, every time, no exceptions.

Why the Matrix

The Cleaning Matrix is built from every complaint we have received over the years. If you follow it, we know every element has been covered. It is a faultless form – so it is never skipped and never rushed.

Why photos and the clock

Your before and after photos show the standard you achieved and protect you if a tenant later complains. The clock shows how long a proper clean takes, so cleans are planned with the time they need.

RECEIVING WORK

2 How your work reaches you

1. **The voids team finish**

   The void team complete the Move-In Prep and certify the home: every defect put right, appliances, hot water and sockets tested. They will not need access again.

2. **You are instructed**

   You get an alert in NicoNet – “Clean now due: [home]” – and a push to your phone. The clean appears in **Today › My jobs** as **V5 · Cleaning Matrix** on that home, with the date it must be ready by and the move-in date.

3. **Keys**

   Collect the keys from the office and sign them out in **Work › Keys & tools**; sign them back the same day.

4. **Working alone**

   Check in under **Today › Lone working** with your expected finish time. Tap I’m safe during the clean and Check out when you leave. Not checked out 30 minutes after your finish time? Kevin is alerted and will call you.

SOMETHING NOT READY?

If you arrive and the void work is not finished – tools left, defects not put right – tell the office in Messages before you start. Do not clean around unfinished work.

ON SITE

3 The clean, step by step

1. **Start job – clock on**

   In My jobs, open V5 on the home and press ▶ **Start job · start clock** when you arrive. The clock runs on our server and your position is recorded once.

2. **On arrival – start these first**

   Apply toilet unblocker gel to the toilet and drain unblocker to every sink and basin straight away, so they have time to work. Fill the kettle: clean with warm water at all times.

3. **Before photos**

   Press **Take before photo**. Photograph every room as you find it – kitchen, bathroom, each bedroom, living room, hallway – and the communal entrance. Before photos can only be taken while the clock runs.

4. **Clean**

   Clean to N3 Cleaning and every line of the Cleaning Matrix, room by room. Move it, clean it, put it back.

5. **Stop the clock**

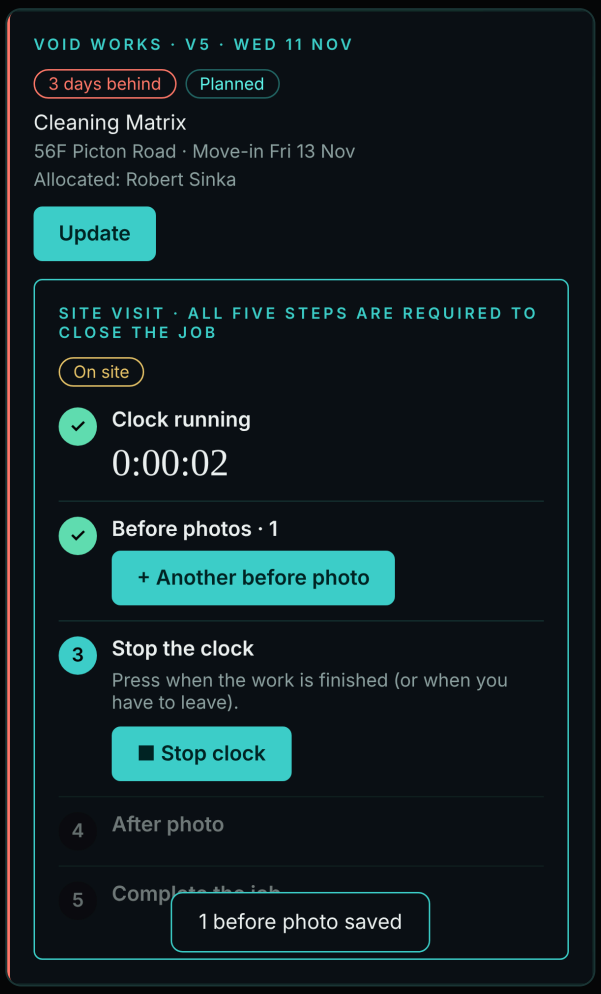
   Press ■ **Stop clock** when the clean is finished. It will not stop without a before photo.

6. **After photos**

   Photograph every room finished, from the same angles as the before. They can only be taken once the clock has stopped, and cannot be changed or deleted once saved.

7. **Cleaning Matrix and Finish clean**

   Mark every Matrix line **Done** or **N/A**, write what you did, and press ✓ **Finish clean**.



V5 on My jobs: clock running, before photo saved

NO MATRIX, NO RELEASE

The clean cannot be finished without the clock times, the before and after photos and every Matrix line. The home cannot be let until it is.

THE FORM

4 The Cleaning Matrix

Every line, every clean. In the app each line is marked **Done** or **N/A**; N/A only where it genuinely does not apply to the home (no bath, no furniture supplied).

KITCHEN

- ☐ Kitchen cupboards and drawers cleaned inside, outside and on top
- ☐ Appliances cleaned inside and out
- ☐ Oven, racks and trays cleaned (glass removed by maintenance where needed)
- ☐ Fridge freezer cleaned, deodoriser left in
- ☐ Kitchen extractor degreased
- ☐ Splashback tiles and grout bleached

BATHROOM

- ☐ Toilet cleaned, sanitary band fitted
- ☐ Bath and shower tray cleaned
- ☐ Shower head cleaned top and bottom
- ☐ Shower screen cleaned both sides; seal soaked or replaced
- ☐ Tiles, grout and silicone bleached and scrubbed
- ☐ Mirror cleaned and buffed
- ☐ Bathroom cupboards cleaned
- ☐ Extractor fan and cover cleaned
- ☐ Taps cleaned, finish checked

BEDROOMS AND FURNITURE

- ☐ Bed, headboard and mattress wet vacced
- ☐ New mattress protector fitted
- ☐ Under bed cleaned
- ☐ Chests of drawers and bedsides cleaned inside, outside and back
- ☐ Wardrobes and all furniture cleaned inside and out
- ☐ Furniture moved and floor cleaned underneath and behind
- ☐ Sofa wet vacced and freshened
- ☐ Stickers and labels removed

THROUGHOUT

- ☐ Floors hoovered, including edges and corners
- ☐ Laminate steam mopped with all-purpose cleaner
- ☐ Carpets wet vacced where needed, carpet powder applied
- ☐ Paint and marks scraped off floors
- ☐ All doors cleaned both sides and buffed
- ☐ Paint cleaned from handles, sockets and switches
- ☐ Skirting and architraves dusted and wiped
- ☐ Ceiling corners, light fittings, spotlights, banisters and handrails dusted
- ☐ Radiators and heaters dusted
- ☐ Detector heads dusted
- ☐ Internal windows, glass and sills cleaned

FINISH

- ☐ All rubbish bagged and placed in our bins
- ☐ Nothing left in the property
- ☐ Air freshener or plug-in applied at the end of the clean

COMMUNAL AREAS

- ☐ Main entrance door, glass, frame and mat clean
- ☐ Stairs, landings and floors cleaned with fresh water – no dirty-mop smell
- ☐ Handrails, light switches, post boxes and doors wiped; no cobwebs
- ☐ Organised, clutter-free and smelling fresh

IN THE APP

Completing the Matrix in NicoNet

VOID WORKS · V5 · WED 11 NOV

3 days behind | Planned

Cleaning Matrix
56F Picton Road · Move-in Fri 13 Nov
Allocated: Robert Sinka

Update

SITE VISIT · ALL FIVE STEPS ARE REQUIRED TO CLOSE THE JOB

1 min on site

- ✓ Started 07:56
- ✓ Before photos · 1
- ✓ Clock stopped 07:56
- ✓ After photos · 1
  + Another after photo
- 5 Complete the job

CLEANING MATRIX · EVERY LINE DONE OR N/A

Kitchen

Kitchen cupboards and drawers cleaned inside, outside and on top	Done	N/A
Appliances cleaned inside and out	Done	N/A
Oven, racks and trays cleaned (glass removed by maintenance where needed)	Done	N/A
Fridge freezer cleaned, deodoriser left in	Done	N/A
Kitchen extractor degreased	Done	N/A
Splashback tiles and grout bleached	Done	N/A

After the after photos, step 5 opens the Cleaning Matrix

Every line, Done or N/A

Tap **Done** once the line is cleaned to standard. Tap **N/A** only where the item does not exist in this home. A line left blank stops you finishing.

What you did

A short note for management: anything extra you did, and anything you could not clean to standard and have reported.

Finish clean

Lights up only when every line is answered and the note is written. It sends the Matrix, your clock times and your photos to NicoMGT.

Communal areas

Main entrance door, glass, frame and mat clean	Done	N/A
Stairs, landings and floors cleaned with fresh water – no dirty-mop smell	Done	N/A
Handrails, light switches, post boxes and doors wiped; no cobwebs	Done	N/A
Organised, clutter-free and smelling fresh	Done	N/A

WHAT YOU DID (MANAGEMENT SEES THIS)

ınd the Matrix; bed 2 blind stain reported

✓ Finish clean

NicoMGT gets the Cleaning Matrix and your photos, and the manager is told the Move-In Quality Check is due.

Communal lines, the note and Finish clean

COMMUNAL

5 First impressions start at the main door

Every move-in clean includes the communal areas: the entrance, the stairs and the landings the tenant walks through on the way in.

Clean

Entrance door, glass, frame and mat; stairs and landings swept and mopped; handrails, light switches, post boxes and doors wiped; no cobwebs.

Organised

Nothing left in halls or on stairs. Furniture or obstructions in an escape route: remove if you can, otherwise tell the office immediately.

Fresh

Fresh water every time, never a dirty mop. It must smell clean and fresh – a dirty-mop smell will put a tenant off before they reach the door.

TELL THE OFFICE

Fire alarm panel red or amber: immediately. Communal door won't lock or close, D handle missing, light not working: the same day.

AFTER

6 Finish clean and what happens next

1. **Management is alerted**

   “Clean finished: [home]”, with your Cleaning Matrix, your clock times and your before and after photos in NicoMGT › Job sign-off.

2. **Reviewed**

   Management checks your photos and Matrix and signs the clean off, or sends it back to your My jobs with what needs doing.

3. **The quality check**

   The manager visits the home and completes the Move-In Quality Check: 29 checks, starting with the clean. Anything that fails comes back to you before the home can be certified ready for occupation.

4. **Move-in**

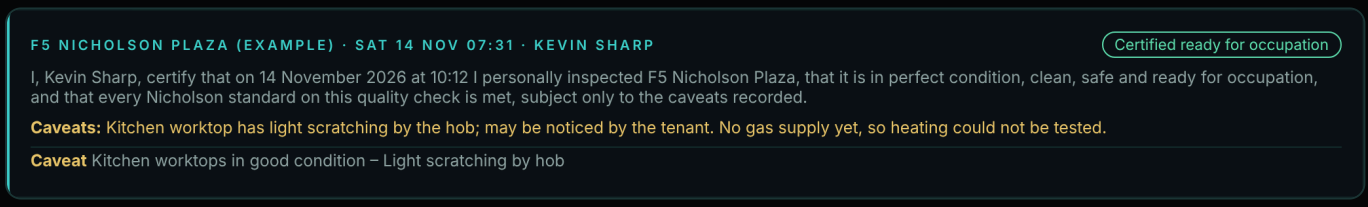
   The tenant arrives to the home you left. Your work is the first thing they see.

Can’t clean something to standard?

Grout that won’t clean, heavy mould on seals, a damaged tap finish, a stained blind: tell the office or the team the same day so it is put right before move-in. Report, don’t hide.

Stock

Stock is your responsibility. Tell the office before anything runs out so it is ordered in good time.



What management sees: NicoMGT › Move-In Quality Check

SOP · N3-C

N3 The Nicholson Non-Negotiables

Every clean, every time. These standards apply to every move-in clean and every communal clean, whether or not they are on the job sheet. They are not optional and they are not “if time allows”. A home that misses one of them is not finished.

Every clean, every time

If it is on this list, it is done. The job sheet adds to N3; it never replaces it.

Move it, clean it, put it back

Every piece of furniture is moved so underneath and behind are cleaned. Too heavy? Ask for help — never skip it.

Report, don’t hide

If something can’t be cleaned to standard, tell the office the same day so it is put right before move-in.

Sign the Cleaning Matrix

Every move-in clean ends with the Cleaning Matrix completed and signed in NicoNet. No matrix, no release.

N3-C Move-in cleans

ON ARRIVAL — START THESE FIRST

- ☐ Apply toilet unblocker gel to the toilet as soon as you arrive, so it has time to work.
- ☐ Apply drain unblocker to every sink and basin as soon as you arrive, for the same reason.
- ☐ Clean with warm water at all times. A kettle is provided — use it.

KITCHEN AND APPLIANCES

- ☐ Oven: use the Oven Pride kit and put the racks and trays in to soak. Use Cillit Bang Burnt-On Degreaser where needed. Trays beyond reasonable condition: tell the office.
- ☐ Oven glass dirty between the panes: ask the office to arrange removal so it can be cleaned inside and refitted.
- ☐ Empty every kitchen unit and clean inside. Wipe all fronts with all-purpose cloths and buff with a microfibre cloth — no swirl marks.
- ☐ Clean the tops of the kitchen units using the step ladders provided.
- ☐ Clean every appliance inside and out, and leave a fridge deodoriser in the fridge.
- ☐ Degrease the kitchen extractor vent covers.
- ☐ Bleach all tiles and grout in active areas, including the splashback.

BATHROOM

- ☐ Toilet: bleach, scrub with the brushes and apply toilet cleaner until it is gleaming, then fit a sanitary band.
- ☐ Taps: apply Cillit Bang foam, leave it to work, then rinse. Check the finish afterwards — if any coating has come off, tell the team so it can be resprayed.
- ☐ Bleach all tiles and grout in active areas: shower trays, baths and around the shower. Grout beyond cleaning: tell the team promptly so it is regrouted.
- ☐ Shower and bath screen seals: remove, soak in bleach and refit. Too much mildew or mould: tell the team so the seal is replaced.
- ☐ Mirrors and shower or bath screens: clean both sides with Windolene and the window vacuum and scraper set, then buff — no streaks, no mildew.
- ☐ Wipe the bathroom extractor fan and cover clean.

N3-C Move-in cleans (continued)

BEDS, FURNITURE AND SOFT FURNISHINGS

- ☐ Move all furniture and clean underneath and behind it, then put it back. Too heavy: ask for help.
- ☐ Clean all furniture inside and out — every drawer, wardrobe, bedside and chest of drawers, including the back.
- ☐ Upholstered furniture: clean with Dr Beckmann upholstery cleaner, wet vac, then finish with fabric freshener spray.
- ☐ Mattresses: wet vac and treat stains first where needed, then fit a new full-zip mattress protector to every mattress.
- ☐ Remove any stickers and labels left on furniture or worktops (often lettering left from assembly).

FLOORS

- ☐ Hoover every floor throughout, including corners and edges where dust settles.
- ☐ Laminate: mop with the Kärcher steam mop and all-purpose cleaner — never water alone.
- ☐ Carpets: wet vac where needed, and at all times finish with scented carpet powder.
- ☐ Every floor free from marks and paint. Use the scrapers supplied.

DOORS, WOODWORK, WALLS AND FITTINGS

- ☐ Clean every door on both sides with all-purpose cloths and buff with microfibre — no swirl marks.
- ☐ Wipe over every handle in the home and remove any paint.
- ☐ Dust tops of doors, architraves and light fittings with the long-handled duster.
- ☐ Dust skirting, then wet wipe with Dettol all-purpose cloths.
- ☐ Dust ceiling corners in every room — cobwebs collect there.
- ☐ Dust all radiators and wall heaters, so dust doesn't burn and smell when they are switched on.
- ☐ Dust every smoke and heat detector head.
- ☐ Dust handrails and spindles.
- ☐ LED shelving or skirting lights: clean inside so they are free of dust and debris.

WINDOWS AND GLASS

- ☐ Clean all windows and glass with Windolene and the window vacuum and scraper set, then buff — no streaks.
- ☐ Wipe and dust every window sill.

N3-C Move-in cleans (continued)

FINISH AND LEAVE

- ☐ Nothing is left in the property. All rubbish goes out in the bin bags provided.
- ☐ Apply air freshener before you leave, so the home smells fresh for the new resident.
- ☐ Complete and sign the Cleaning Matrix in NicoNet before you leave.

N3-C Communal cleans

STAIRS, HANDRAILS AND WOODWORK

- ☐ Clean handrails, risers and spindles with Dettol wipes and dust with a microfibre cloth.
- ☐ Dust skirting, architrave and all light fittings.
- ☐ Clean the under-stairs areas.

FLOORS

- ☐ Communal carpets: hoover at all times with scented carpet powder, and wet vac where appropriate.
- ☐ Laminate: steam mop with all-purpose cleaner.

DOORS, CUPBOARDS AND LIFTS

- ☐ Wipe every door on both sides with Dettol wipes and buff with microfibre.
- ☐ Check every communal cupboard and make sure it is clear.
- ☐ Passenger lifts: clean inside, using the mirror cleaning products on mirrored and gloss surfaces.

WINDOWS

- ☐ Clean windows with Windolene and the window cleaning kit.
- ☐ Wipe and dust sills so they are free of dirt and rubbish.

CLEAR ROUTES — FIRE SAFETY

- ☐ Remove every item left in communal areas and bag all rubbish.
- ☐ Keep the top of the fire alarm panel clear.
- ☐ No door is ever wedged or jammed open. Fire doors must close and latch.
- ☐ Post any letters under each apartment door so the letterbox area stays clear at all times.
- ☐ Clear rubbish from the immediate outside of every building entrance.

REPORT Report, don't hide

IF YOU FIND	WHAT TO DO
Fire alarm panel showing red or amber	Tell the office immediately
Furniture or obstructions in halls or escape routes	Remove if you can; otherwise tell the office immediately
Communal door won't lock, won't close, or a D handle is missing	Tell the office the same day
Communal light not working or bulb missing	Tell the office the same day
Oven trays beyond reasonable condition, or oven glass needs removing	Tell the office the same day
Grout that won't clean, or seals with heavy mould	Tell the team the same day so it is regrouted or replaced
Tap or fitting finish damaged after cleaning	Tell the team so it is resprayed
Blind stained or damaged	Tell the office so it is cleaned or reordered
Cleaning stock running low	Tell the office before you run out

STOCK

Stock is your responsibility. Tell the office when anything is running low — before it runs out — so it is ordered in good time.

Sign the N3

Open **NicoNet › SOP › Cleaning**, watch the film, read the standards and sign at the bottom. Your signature is recorded with the date and time on your staff file. You sign again whenever the N3 changes.

KIT What you carry, every job

- ☐ Toilet unblocker gel
- ☐ Sink drain unblocker
- ☐ Kettle (warm water)
- ☐ Oven Pride kit
- ☐ Cillit Bang Burnt-On Degreaser
- ☐ Cillit Bang foam
- ☐ Bleach and toilet cleaner
- ☐ Sanitary bands
- ☐ Dr Beckmann upholstery cleaner
- ☐ Wet vac
- ☐ Fabric freshener
- ☐ Full-zip mattress protectors
- ☐ Stain remover
- ☐ Windolene
- ☐ Window vacuum and scraper set
- ☐ Microfibre cloths
- ☐ Dettol all-purpose cloths and wipes
- ☐ Long-handled duster
- ☐ Step ladders
- ☐ Floor scrapers
- ☐ Kärcher steam mop
- ☐ All-purpose floor cleaner
- ☐ Scented carpet powder
- ☐ Fridge deodoriser
- ☐ Air freshener and plug-ins
- ☐ Bin bags

THE APP

7 Using NicoNet for the clean

QUESTION	ANSWER
How do I sign in?	Your work email, then the six-digit code we email you. No password. Check junk if it has not arrived.
Where is my clean?	Today › My jobs. Filter Void works. Your clean is V5 on the home.
The camera does not open	Allow NicoNet to use the camera: Settings › NicoNet › Camera.
“Take at least one before photo before you stop the clock”	Take the before photos first, then stop the clock.
“Stop the job clock first, then take the after photos”	After photos come after the clock stops.
“Complete every line of the Cleaning Matrix”	Every line needs Done or N/A before Finish clean.
I pressed Start by mistake / at the wrong home	Tell the office in Messages straight away.
I have to leave before I finish	Stop the clock, press Couldn’t finish on this visit, choose Delayed and say why. Start job again when you return.
The clean was sent back	Read the reason on the job, go back, Start job and put it right.

SIGN-OFF

Acknowledgement

I confirm that I have read this Cleaning workflow guide in full, that I understand how my work reaches me in NicoNet, the steps I must follow and the standards I am held to, and that I will follow them on every job.

I understand that the app records the times I start and stop, my position when I do, my photos and my reports, and that this record is used to manage the work, to evidence it to residents, councils, ombudsmen and courts, and at my appraisal. I understand that a job I have not closed in the app is not complete, and that I will not be credited with it.

Name (block capitals) _____ Signature _____

Date _____ Line manager _____

Return the signed page to Kevin Sharp, or sign the N3 in NicoNet › SOP where the same acknowledgement is recorded on your file.